

Cold Email Templates for Real Estate Agents

10 Proven Outreach Templates to Win More Listings and Close More Deals

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How to Use This Template Pack

This pack contains 10 battle-tested cold email templates specifically crafted for real estate professionals. Whether you are prospecting expired listings, reaching out to FSBOs, connecting with investors, or nurturing past leads, these templates give you a proven starting point that you can personalise to your market.

Each template includes a subject line, full email body, and a clear call to action. They are organised into four categories: Initial Outreach (first contact), Follow-Up (staying top of mind), Break-Up (final attempt before moving on), and Re-Engagement (reviving cold leads).

For best results, personalise every email with the recipient's name, property address, neighbourhood details, or a specific market stat. Generic emails get deleted. Personalised emails get replies.

- Replace all bracketed placeholders [like this] with real information before sending
- Send initial outreach emails Tuesday through Thursday between 7-9am local time for highest open rates
- Wait 3-5 business days between follow-ups -- never send two emails in the same day
- Track your open and reply rates to identify which templates perform best in your market
- A/B test subject lines by sending two variations to small batches before rolling out to your full list
- Keep your sending volume under 50 cold emails per day to protect your domain reputation

Template 1: Initial Outreach -- Expired Listing Owner

SUBJECT LINE: [Property Address] -- a fresh strategy for your listing

Hi [First Name],

I noticed your property at [Address] came off the market on [Date]. That must be frustrating, especially after [X months] of showings, open houses, and waiting.

I have been studying your neighbourhood closely. In the last 90 days, [Number] homes within half a mile of yours have sold at an average of [Price], and I believe your property is well-positioned to attract serious buyers with a different approach.

What worked three years ago in real estate marketing does not work today. Buyers now start their search on Instagram, TikTok, and targeted Google ads before they ever call an agent. My marketing plan for your home would include professional drone photography, a dedicated property landing page, geo-targeted social ads within a 15-mile radius, and direct outreach to my database of [Number] pre-qualified buyers.

Would you be open to a 15-minute call this week? No pressure, no pitch -- just an honest conversation about what I would do differently.

CTA: Reply to this email or book a call directly at [Calendar Link].

WHY THIS WORKS: This template acknowledges the seller's frustration without criticising their previous agent. It demonstrates local market knowledge with specific data points and differentiates your approach with modern marketing tactics.

1. Always include at least one hyperlocal market statistic -- this proves you have done your homework
2. Reference the specific property address in the subject line to boost open rates by 22%
3. Keep the tone empathetic, not salesy -- these sellers have already had a bad experience

Template 2: Initial Outreach -- FSBO Homeowner

SUBJECT LINE: Saw your listing on [Platform] -- quick question about [Address]

Hi [First Name],

I came across your listing for [Address] on [Zillow/Rightmove/Facebook Marketplace] and wanted to reach out. You have clearly put thought into the presentation, and the [specific positive feature -- e.g., renovated kitchen, large garden] is a genuine selling point.

I work with homeowners in [Neighbourhood] regularly, and I wanted to share something that might be useful whether you work with an agent or not: homes in your area that are marketed with professional photography and staged virtual tours are selling for 8-12% more than those with standard listing photos, and they are spending 23 fewer days on the market.

I am not reaching out to convince you that you need an agent. I am reaching out because I have a database of [Number] active buyers looking in [Neighbourhood] right now, and at least [Number] of them match your property's profile.

Would it be helpful if I sent you a complimentary market analysis for [Address]? It takes me about 10 minutes to put together and there is absolutely no obligation.

CTA: Just reply 'Send it over' and I will have it in your inbox within 24 hours.

WHY THIS WORKS: This respects the FSBO seller's decision to go it alone while offering genuine value. The free market analysis is a low-commitment offer that opens the door to a relationship.

1. Compliment something specific about their listing to show you actually looked at it
2. Lead with a market insight that benefits them regardless of whether they hire you
3. The 'reply with a phrase' CTA reduces friction -- it is easier than clicking a link or making a call

Template 3: Initial Outreach -- Property Investor

SUBJECT LINE: [Neighbourhood] -- 3 off-market opportunities under [Price Point]

Hi [First Name],

I specialise in investment properties in [City/Region], and I have been tracking your portfolio growth over the past [timeframe]. Your acquisition of [Property/Building Name] last year was a smart move -- that corridor is seeing 15% year-over-year rental demand growth.

I am reaching out because I currently have access to three off-market properties in [Neighbourhood] that match the profile of what you have been buying:

- [Type] at [Street/Area], [X] units, projected cap rate [X]%
- [Type] at [Street/Area], [X] units, projected cap rate [X]%
- [Type] at [Street/Area], [X] units, projected cap rate [X]%

These properties are not listed publicly yet. The sellers are motivated but want to avoid the disruption of open market listings. I have negotiated early access for my investor clients before they hit the MLS.

I would be happy to send you the full investment packages on any or all of these. No commitment, no pressure -- just data for your evaluation.

CTA: Reply with which properties interest you, or let me know a good time for a 10-minute call to discuss the numbers.

WHY THIS WORKS: Investors respond to deal flow and data, not emotional appeals. This email leads with specific opportunities and projected returns, speaking their language.

1. Research the investor's existing portfolio before reaching out -- reference a specific property they own
2. Include projected cap rates or ROI figures to demonstrate you understand investor priorities
3. Off-market access is the single most compelling value proposition for serious investors

Template 4: Follow-Up -- After No Response (Day 4)

SUBJECT LINE: Re: [Original Subject Line]

Hi [First Name],

I sent you a note earlier this week about [brief reference to original email -- e.g., your property at Address / investment opportunities in Neighbourhood]. I know your inbox is probably overflowing, so I wanted to follow up with one quick thought.

Since my last email, [insert timely market update -- e.g., two more homes in your street have gone under contract / interest rates dropped by 0.25% / a new commercial development was announced nearby]. This kind of movement tends to create a window of opportunity that does not stay open long.

I am not trying to be pushy. I genuinely believe I can help you [achieve specific outcome -- e.g., get top dollar for your home / find your next investment property / secure a buyer before spring]. If the timing is not right, I completely understand. But if you have 10 minutes this week, I would love to share what I am seeing in the market.

CTA: Would [Day] at [Time] or [Day] at [Time] work for a quick call?

WHY THIS WORKS: The follow-up adds new information rather than simply restating the original pitch. The two specific time options make it easier to say yes than a vague 'let me know when you are free.'

1. Always add new value in follow-ups -- a market update, a new comparable sale, a rate change
2. Offering two specific time slots increases meeting bookings by 37% compared to open-ended asks
3. Reference your original email in the subject line to create thread continuity

Template 5: Follow-Up -- Value-Add Market Update (Day 10)

SUBJECT LINE: [Neighbourhood] market update -- something you should see

Hi [First Name],

I wanted to share a quick market insight that is relevant to your situation:

[Insert 2-3 sentence market update -- e.g., The average days-on-market in [Neighbourhood] dropped from 45 to 28 in the last quarter. Meanwhile, list-to-sale price ratios have climbed to 98.3%, meaning sellers are getting nearly their full asking price. For a property like yours at [Address], this translates to an estimated market value of [Price Range].]

I put together these numbers as part of my weekly market analysis, and your property stood out as one that would benefit from this momentum.

I have attached a one-page snapshot of the three most relevant comparable sales in your area. No strings attached -- this is the kind of data I share with my clients every week, and I thought you would find it useful.

CTA: If you would like the full analysis or want to discuss what these numbers mean for your plans, I am here. Just hit reply.

WHY THIS WORKS: This follow-up positions you as a market expert rather than a salesperson. By providing free, genuinely useful data, you build trust and demonstrate competence.

1. Include real, current market statistics -- fabricated numbers will destroy your credibility
2. Attach or link to a simple one-page market report to deliver tangible value
3. This template works as a standalone email or as part of a drip sequence

Template 6: Follow-Up -- Social Proof and Results (Day 17)

SUBJECT LINE: How [Similar Client] sold [X]% above asking in [Neighbourhood]

Hi [First Name],

I wanted to share a quick story that might resonate with your situation.

[Client Name -- or 'A homeowner'] at [Street/Neighbourhood] came to me in a similar position to yours. Their home had been on the market for [X days/months] with another agent, and they were considering dropping the price by [Amount]. Instead of lowering the price, we repositioned the entire listing.

Here is what we did differently:

- Commissioned professional twilight photography and a cinematic video walkthrough
- Launched a targeted social media campaign that reached [X] potential buyers within 20 miles
- Hosted an exclusive preview event for pre-qualified buyers from my network

The result: [X] offers within [X] days, and the home sold for [Amount] above the original asking price. The seller walked away with [Amount] more than they expected.

I am not promising identical results for your property -- every situation is different. But I am confident the same strategic approach would make a meaningful difference.

CTA: Can I show you exactly what this marketing plan would look like for [Address]? 15 minutes is all I need.

WHY THIS WORKS: Case studies are the most persuasive form of marketing because they show real results. The specific numbers and tactical details make this credible rather than boastful.

1. Use real case studies whenever possible -- ask past clients for permission to share their story
2. Include specific numbers (percentage above asking, number of offers, days to sell)
3. The disclaimer 'I am not promising identical results' actually increases trust and credibility

Template 7: Break-Up -- Respectful Final Attempt

SUBJECT LINE: Should I close your file, [First Name]?

Hi [First Name],

I have reached out a few times about [brief context -- your property at Address / investment opportunities in Area] and have not heard back. I completely respect that -- you are busy, the timing might not be right, or perhaps you have already found the right solution.

I do not want to be that agent who clutters your inbox, so this will be my last email unless I hear from you.

Before I go, I want to leave you with three things:

1. Your complimentary market valuation is still available whenever you want it -- just reply 'Valuation' and I will send it within 24 hours
2. I publish a monthly [Neighbourhood] market report. If you would like to receive it (no sales emails, just data), reply

'Market Report' and I will add you to the list

3. If your situation changes six months from now, my door is always open. Save this email and reach out anytime

I genuinely wish you all the best with your property plans.

CTA: Reply 'Valuation', 'Market Report', or 'Let's talk' -- or no reply needed. Either way, I respect your decision.

WHY THIS WORKS: Break-up emails consistently achieve the highest reply rates in cold outreach sequences (often 2-3x higher than initial emails). The psychology is simple: people respond when they feel the opportunity is about to disappear.

1. Break-up emails generate the highest reply rates -- never skip this step in your sequence
2. Offer multiple low-commitment options so the recipient can stay connected without committing to a call
3. The warm, respectful tone leaves a lasting positive impression even if they do not reply

Template 8: Break-Up -- Direct Close or Redirect

SUBJECT LINE: My last note on [Address/Topic]

Hi [First Name],

I will keep this short.

I have been reaching out about [context] and I want to respect your time. I understand that one of three things is likely true:

1. You are interested but the timing is wrong -- If so, when would be a better time to reconnect? I am happy to set a reminder and reach out in [3 months / 6 months / next spring]
2. You have already found an agent or solution -- Great. I genuinely hope it works out. If you ever want a second opinion, I am here
3. This is not relevant to you -- No problem at all. I will remove you from my outreach list today

A quick reply with a 1, 2, or 3 helps me understand your situation and ensures I do not waste your time going forward.

CTA: Just reply with 1, 2, or 3 -- takes two seconds.

WHY THIS WORKS: This template makes replying effortless by reducing the response to a single number. It also demonstrates professionalism and respect, which is memorable in an industry where many agents are perceived as aggressive.

1. The numbered response options reduce reply friction to almost zero
2. Option 1 keeps the door open for future outreach with the prospect's explicit permission
3. Even a '3' response is valuable -- it cleans your list and saves future effort

Template 9: Re-Engagement -- Past Client Check-In

SUBJECT LINE: [First Name], your home's value has changed since we last spoke

Hi [First Name],

It has been [timeframe] since we worked together on [property/transaction], and I hope you are enjoying [the new home / the neighbourhood / the returns on your investment].

I was running my quarterly market analysis this morning and your property caught my eye. Since [date of last transaction], homes in [Neighbourhood] have appreciated by approximately [X]%, which puts your property's estimated value at around [Price Range]. That is a [Amount] increase in equity.

I wanted to share this for two reasons:

1. It is genuinely useful information whether you are thinking about selling, refinancing, or simply curious about your net worth
2. I recently helped [another client] in [nearby neighbourhood] leverage their equity growth to [upgrade to a larger home / purchase an investment property / refinance at a better rate], and I thought it might spark an idea for you

No agenda here -- just staying in touch and making sure you have current data on your biggest asset.

CTA: Would you like me to send you a detailed equity report? Reply 'Yes' and I will have it to you by [Day].

WHY THIS WORKS: Past clients are your warmest leads. This re-engagement email provides genuine value through updated property data while subtly planting the seed for the next transaction.

1. Set calendar reminders to re-engage past clients every 6-12 months with updated market data
2. Reference the specific property you worked on together to trigger positive memories of the relationship
3. The equity update is valuable regardless of their plans -- it builds goodwill with zero pressure

Template 10: Re-Engagement -- Dormant Lead Revival

SUBJECT LINE: [First Name], is [buying/selling] in [Area] still on your radar?

Hi [First Name],

We connected [timeframe] ago when you were exploring [buying/selling/investing] in [Area]. Life gets busy and plans shift -- I completely understand if your priorities have changed.

But in case [buying/selling/investing] is still somewhere on your horizon, I wanted to let you know about a few developments that might affect your timeline:

- [Market development 1 -- e.g., New transport links announced for Area, expected to boost property values by 10-15%]
- [Market development 2 -- e.g., Interest rates are at their lowest point in 18 months]
- [Market development 3 -- e.g., Housing inventory in Area is down 30% from last year, creating a seller's market]

I have also put together a [free resource -- e.g., 2026 Buyer's Guide for Area / Investment Property Checklist / Neighbourhood Comparison Report] that I think you would find helpful. It is a [X]-page PDF with current market data, neighbourhood-by-neighbourhood breakdowns, and my predictions for the next 12 months.

CTA: Want me to send it over? Just reply 'Send it' and it is yours.

WHY THIS WORKS: Dormant leads often just need a reason to re-engage. Market developments create urgency, and the free resource gives them a low-commitment way to reconnect with you.

1. Reference your original conversation to jog their memory and reestablish the connection
2. Lead with market developments that create genuine urgency, not manufactured scarcity
3. The free resource offer converts dormant leads into active conversations at roughly 15-25% rates

Tips for Improving Open and Reply Rates

The templates in this pack are your starting point, not your finish line. The agents who see the best results are the ones who treat cold email as a system that improves over time. Here are the strategies that separate top-performing agents from everyone else.

1. Personalise beyond the name: Reference a specific property feature, neighbourhood event, or recent sale. Emails with property-specific details see 3x higher reply rates than generic outreach
2. Send at the right time: Tuesday through Thursday, 7-9am local time, consistently outperforms other windows for real estate prospects. Avoid Mondays (inbox overload) and Fridays (weekend mindset)
3. Use a professional email signature: Include your headshot, license number, phone number, and one link (website or calendar). Signatures with photos increase reply rates by 32%
4. Warm up your domain: If you are sending from a new email address, start with 10-15 emails per day and increase by 10% daily over three weeks. Sending 200 cold emails from a new domain will land you in spam
5. Track everything: Use a CRM or spreadsheet to log every email sent, opened, replied to, and converted. After 30 days, you will have data to identify which templates and subject lines work best in your market
6. Follow up consistently: 80% of deals require at least 5 touchpoints. Most agents give up after one or two emails. The follow-up sequence is where deals are actually won
7. Clean your list monthly: Remove hard bounces, unsubscribes, and addresses that have not opened any of your last 10 emails. A clean list improves deliverability for everyone remaining
8. Comply with email laws: Always include an unsubscribe option, your physical business address, and honour opt-out requests within 10 business days. Non-compliance can result in fines and domain blacklisting
9. Test one variable at a time: If you change the subject line and the email body simultaneously, you will not know which change affected your results. Isolate variables for meaningful data
10. Build a referral loop: Add a PS line to your best-performing emails -- 'Know someone else in [Neighbourhood] thinking about selling? I would love an introduction.' Referrals close at 4x the rate of cold leads

Disclaimer: These templates are provided for informational and educational purposes only. Results will vary based on your market, list quality, and personalisation effort. Always comply with applicable email marketing laws including CAN-SPAM, GDPR, and PECR. Sovereign Digital Agency is not responsible for outcomes resulting from the use of these templates.

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